ference on November 30th and December 1st, eight times before the Federal Structure Committee and twice before the Minorities Committee. In his maiden speech before the Federal Structure Committee on September 15th, 1931, he explained the position of the Indian National Congress and the mandate given by the Karachi Congress and went on to say : 'Time was when I prided myself on being and being called a British subject. I have ceased for many years to call myself a British subject; I would far rather be called a rebel than a subject But I have now aspired—and I still aspire—to be a citizen, not in the Empire but in a Commonwealth, in a partnership if possible, if God wills it, an indissoluble partnership but not a partnership superimposed upon one nation by another.' (It is clear from this speech that in spite of the Lahore resolution on independence, the Mahatma was striving for a settlement with Britain on the basis of Dominion Status)

In the Press interview which the Mahatma had granted on board S. S *Rajputana,* it was evident that he was full of optimism. But before the second meeting of the Federal Structure Committee which took place on September 17th, disillusionment began to creep in He began to realise of what stuff the members of the Round Table Conference were made Therefore at the outset of his speech on September 17th, he said . 'I have endeavoured to study, as I had not done before, the list of the delegates; and the first feeling of oppression that has been coming upon me is that we are not the chosen ones of the nation which we should be representing, but we are the chosen ones of the Government Furthermore, knowing well the different parties and groups in India from experience, as I study the list of delegates I see some very noticeable gaps,[1] and so I am oppressed with a sense of unreality in connection with our composition ' The Mahatma began to see through the game of the British politicians—hence in order to turn the tables on them he called upon them to make concrete proposals (In reply to that move, the Government sought to turn the tables on him by summoning the Minorities Committee which would form the battle-ground for the Indian delegates.) In

the depressed classes 2 from Labour 2 Sikhs 1 Parsi 2 Indian Christians, 2 Britishers domiciled in India 1 Anglo Indian and 3 women—total 44 The Moslems who are 1 quarter of the Indian population had the largest representation and there was only one Nationalist Moslem among them

[1] This reference was to the Nationalist Moslems among others whose absence the Mahatma now began to feel The discovery of the Mahatma one cannot help feeling was rather belated